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# Evidence-Guided Crash Adjudication for LLM-assisted Fuzzing of Third-party Open-source Libraries in Connected Vehicles

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**Abstract**

Connected-vehicle software relies on third-party open-source libraries, making it a relevant application setting for studying crash adjudication in LLM-assisted fuzzing. Advances in Large Language Models (LLMs) have increasingly automated fuzz-driver generation. Nevertheless, directly applying LLMs to raw crash reports can produce many false alerts, while case-by-case triage incurs prohibitive labor costs. To tackle this problem, we propose CrashSage, an evidence-guided framework for post-fuzzing crash adjudication in LLM-assisted fuzzing. Before final LLM analysis, CrashSage prepares crash evidence through three key designs: rule-guided crash attribution, representative selection, and crash-context reconstruction. Rule-guided crash attribution filters low-value reports and likely driver-induced crashes to improve false-alert judgment. Representative selection compares exact and stack signatures among retained reports to identify repeated crash instances and submits only selected representatives to the LLM, reducing redundant analysis. Crash-context reconstruction enriches representatives with static and runtime evidence, helping determine whether the faulty state comes from the generated driver or the target component. Experiments on 1,217 crash reports from 14 third-party open-source libraries relevant to connected-vehicle software show that CrashSage achieves 76.54% precision, 92.56% recall, and an 83.79% F1 score, while reducing LLM submissions from 1,217 to 96 (92.11%). These results support CrashSage as a crash-adjudication aid in this application setting.

**Keywords:** fuzz testing, crash adjudication, large language model, crash attribution, connected vehicle security

# 1 Introduction

Intelligent connected vehicle (ICV) systems increasingly depend on third-party open-source libraries (Petit and Shladover 2015; Sun et al. 2022; Bernardini et al. 2017; Checkoway et al. 2011; Ladisa et al. 2023), causing ICV software to inherit security risks from these libraries. To expose crash-inducing defects in such libraries, fuzz testing is widely adopted (Böhme et al. 2019; Lemieux and Sen 2018; Ding and Le Goues 2021). Yet validating diverse third-party open-source libraries at scale still requires a large number of library-specific fuzz drivers. Recent LLM-assisted fuzzing systems attempt to ease this bottleneck by using LLMs to synthesize fuzz drivers automatically (Meng et al. 2024; Deng et al. 2024, 2023; Xia et al. 2024; Xu et al. 2025).

LLM-assisted fuzzing differs from conventional component fuzzing, where the harness is usually written or reviewed by developers and is therefore treated as trusted during crash inspection. In LLM-assisted fuzzing, the generated driver is not necessarily a trusted harness. It invokes target-component APIs with mutated inputs, but it may omit required initialization, construct invalid arguments, or introduce harness-level memory errors. As a result, a crash report no longer reflects target-component behavior alone, but the interaction between the generated driver and the target component.

This difference leads to three challenges in false-alert judgment, crash localization, and efficiency. First, existing crash adjudication tends to treat crash reports as direct evidence of target-component-attributed crashes, leaving driver-induced false alerts difficult to distinguish from target-component-originated crashes. Second, existing adjudication lacks localization evidence that combines static code context and runtime context, which can lead to inaccurate crash attribution. Third, repeated crash instances triggered during fuzzing may stem from the same underlying failure pattern, but existing workflows still analyze them separately, resulting in redundant triage, localization effort, and LLM submissions.

To address this problem, we propose CrashSage, an evidence-guided crash-adjudication pipeline tailored for LLM-assisted fuzzing with incompetent generated drivers. Rather than reasoning directly over raw crash reports, CrashSage applies rule-guided crash attribution to filter low-value reports and likely driver-induced failures, uses representative selection to reduce repeated crash instances, and performs crash-context reconstruction to localize the origin and propagation of the faulty state for the selected representatives. The resulting evidence is then submitted to LLM analysis for final crash diagnosis. In this way, the LLM reasons over filtered, representative, and localized crash evidence. CrashSage is designed as a post-fuzzing triage aid that reduces the number of reports requiring detailed inspection and prepares attribution evidence for retained representative crashes. The main contributions of this paper are listed as follows.

- CrashSage pipeline. We propose an evidence-guided crash-adjudication pipeline for LLM-assisted fuzzing. By preparing structured crash evidence before model reasoning, CrashSage reframes the LLM from a primary classifier over raw crash text into a final analyzer over curated execution evidence.
- Rule-guided crash attribution. We introduce rule-guided crash attribution over sanitizer signals and stack-frame roles. This stage filters low-value reports and likely driver-induced crashes before LLM analysis, mitigating over-attribution bias in prompt-based methods and improving false-alert judgment.
- Representative selection. We compare exact and stack signatures to identify repeated crash instances and retain representative crashes for subsequent LLM analysis. This selection process

reduces redundant analysis while preserving the relationship between each repeated crash and its representative.

- Crash-context reconstruction. We reconstruct static code context and runtime context for representative crashes to trace a crash across driver and component code. By combining source locations with execution-state evidence, this stage supports crash attribution by distinguishing the visible crash site from the origin of the faulty state.
- Experimental evaluation. We evaluate CrashSage using 1,217 crash reports collected from 14 third-party open-source libraries. Compared with the baseline, the full pipeline achieves 76.54% precision, 92.56% recall, and an 83.79% F1 score, while reducing end-to-end LLM submissions from 1,217 to 96 (92.11%). Runtime context reconstruction and LLM analysis are the main sources of latency, while rule-guided crash attribution and representative selection each require less than 10 ms per report.

The rest of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 reviews related work. Section 3 introduces the LLM-assisted fuzzing framework and its crash-adjudication challenges. Section 4 presents the design of CrashSage, Section 5 reports the evaluation, and Section 7 concludes the paper.

# 2 Related Work

## 2.1 LLM-Assisted Fuzzing

Fuzz testing remains a standard way to expose memory-safety defects in C/C++ software, especially with sanitizer support and continuous fuzzing infrastructure (Böhme et al. 2019; Lemieux and Sen 2018; Serebryany et al. 2012; Stepanov and Serebryany 2015; Ding and Le Goues 2021). In conventional component fuzzing, the driver is usually written or reviewed by developers, so downstream analysis can treat it as part of the trusted harness. However, writing such drivers for diverse libraries and APIs requires substantial manual effort, which limits the scalability of component-level fuzzing.

Recent LLM-assisted fuzzing systems address this scalability problem by using models to infer protocol knowledge, generate inputs, synthesize fuzz drivers, and repair compilation errors. ChatAFL (Meng et al. 2024) guides stateful protocol fuzzing with LLM-derived knowledge; FuzzGPT (Deng et al. 2024) and TitanFuzz (Deng et al. 2023) use LLMs for edge-case or test-input generation; Fuzz4All (Xia et al. 2024) generalizes LLM-based input generation across languages; PromptFuzz (Lyu et al. 2024) studies prompt strategies for C/C++ fuzz-driver generation; and CKGFuzzer (Xu et al. 2025) combines code-knowledge-graph construction with LLM-based driver generation and repair. Surveys of LLM-assisted testing likewise emphasize test generation, input synthesis, and repair (Wang et al. 2024). These systems lower driver-construction cost, but their main optimization target remains the upstream fuzzing workflow. Once a generated driver compiles and produces crashes, crash reports are usually treated as fuzzing outcomes rather than as evidence that must be adjudicated under the assumption that the harness may be incompetent. As a result, existing LLM-assisted fuzzing work does not directly address whether a crash report reflects a driver-induced false alert or a target-component-originated crash.

## 2.2 Automated Crash Diagnosis and Reasoning

Given the post-fuzzing analysis gap left by LLM-assisted fuzzing, a natural question is whether existing crash diagnosis techniques can resolve the resulting crash reports. Early automated diagnosis methods relied on stack-trace signatures and heuristic rules for clustering, localization, and duplicate

detection. Igor (Jiang et al. 2021) clusters fuzz crashes by root cause; FuzzerAid (Joshy and Le 2022) groups crashes using learned fault signatures; CrashLocator (Wu et al. 2014) localizes crashing faults from crash stacks; FaST (Rodrigues et al. 2022) aligns stack traces efficiently; and ReBucket (Dang et al. 2012) clusters duplicate crash reports using call-stack similarity. Related methods enrich crash reports with source, execution, or explanation-oriented evidence: DeepAnalyze (Shetty et al. 2022) localizes crashing faults at scale, CrashTranslator (Huang et al. 2024) reconstructs executable scenarios from stack traces, and Better Debugging (Yan et al. 2024) combines static analysis with LLMs for explainable crash localization.

These techniques provide useful clustering and localization support, but they are most effective when crash evidence is stable and the harness is trusted. This assumption weakens under LLM-generated fuzz drivers. Analyses that do not explicitly localize the failure across driver and component code can mistake a component-visible crash site for a component-originated failure. Localization-oriented methods alleviate part of this ambiguity by recovering static code context, but existing execution enrichment is not designed to bind replay-consistent runtime context to driver/component attribution. Consequently, it may not reveal the runtime values, pointer states, or object states that determine whether the failure originates from driver-side construction or target-component behavior. Likewise, crash clustering can group repeated reports, but it does not by itself decide which representative should receive expensive LLM analysis or how duplicate reports should inherit the representative diagnosis.

LLM-based vulnerability reasoning appears to offer richer semantic judgment for this setting. CVE-LLM enriches vulnerability evaluation with cybersecurity ontologies (Ghosh et al. 2025), while AutoCVSS studies prompting, few-shot examples, and retrieval-augmented generation for CVSS prediction (Sanvito et al. 2025). However, these systems typically reason over curated vulnerability descriptions or structured security context, whereas LLM-assisted fuzzing often yields short crash reports from automatically generated drivers. Direct prompting over such reports lacks the structured semantics assumed by vulnerability-reasoning systems and can amplify over-attribution.

Overall, existing work leaves three gaps for LLM-assisted fuzzing crash adjudication. It does not reliably support false-alert judgment when sanitizer evidence mixes driver behavior with target-component behavior. It lacks attribution-oriented localization that combines static code context and runtime context, making it difficult to determine whether a failure propagates from the generated driver or originates within the target component. It also leaves efficiency concerns when repeated crash instances caused by the same underlying failure pattern are analyzed through separate LLM submissions. This motivates a pipeline that combines rule-guided crash attribution, representative selection, crash-context reconstruction, and LLM-based semantic reasoning before final crash diagnosis.

# 3 LLM-Assisted Fuzzing Framework and Challenges

## 3.1 LLM-Assisted Fuzzing Framework

Figure 1 illustrates the overall workflow of the LLM-assisted fuzzing framework considered in this work. The framework automates the process from modeling component APIs to generating fuzz drivers and collecting crash reports, and consists of three stages: API knowledge modeling, driver generation, and crash-oriented fuzzing (Xu et al. 2025).

API knowledge modeling. This stage first extracts the APIs to be tested from open-source components. Static feature extraction then collects key information about the target APIs and identifies

their relationships. The extracted information is organized into an API knowledge graph, which provides structured API knowledge for subsequent combination planning and driver generation (Xu et al. 2025).

Driver generation. The combination agent summarizes the target APIs and uses the API knowledge graph to plan API combinations. Each planned combination, together with the corresponding API source code and summaries, is provided to the driver generation agent, which synthesizes a fuzz driver that invokes the selected APIs (Meng et al. 2024; Xu et al. 2025; Lyu et al. 2024).

Crash-oriented fuzzing. For each generated driver, the seed-generation agent produces initial seeds. The fuzzing engine iteratively mutates these seeds and executes the driver in an attempt to trigger crashes. When a crash occurs, the sanitizer records the failure and exports the corresponding crash report for subsequent crash adjudication (Böhme et al. 2019; Lemieux and Sen 2018; Serebryany et al. 2012; Stepanov and Serebryany 2015).

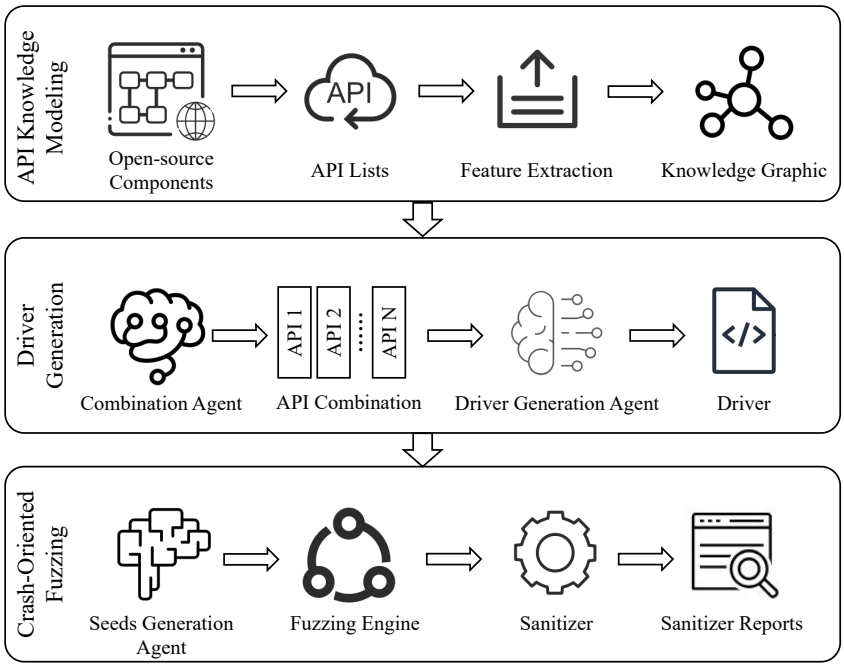



**Fig. 1** Overview of the LLM-assisted fuzzing framework.

In the workflow described above, generated drivers are assumed to be non-malicious but potentially faulty: they may contain unintentional implementation errors or may misuse the target APIs, and we refer to such a driver as an incompetent driver. The assumption is not that every generated driver is faulty, but that a crash report cannot be taken as evidence of a target defect until the driver has been ruled out. A faulty driver may omit required initialization, construct invalid arguments, or otherwise violate API contracts because of unintentional generation errors or insufficient API understanding. We assume that the sanitizer reports, crash artifacts, and source code used for analysis have not been deliberately tampered with. Under these assumptions, rule-guided crash attribution uses sanitizer signals and stack-frame roles to screen likely driver-induced failures. Deliberately malicious drivers,

including those that forge evidence or attempt to evade adjudication, are outside the scope of this work.

### 3.2 Challenges Statement

Unlike conventional fuzzing, LLM-assisted fuzzing cannot assume that the generated driver is a trusted harness (Xu et al. 2025; Lyu et al. 2024). A reported crash may result from the target component, the generated driver, or their interaction under a mutated input. Consequently, the crash report alone may not provide sufficient evidence for reliable post-fuzzing analysis. This setting raises three challenges: false-alert judgment, crash localization, and efficiency.

False-alert judgment. An LLM-generated driver may violate implicit API contracts by omitting required initialization, constructing inconsistent object states, or passing invalid argument combinations. Such misuse can trigger a failure while execution is inside the target component, causing the sanitizer stack trace to contain component frames even when the underlying fault originates from the driver. The presence of a component frame therefore does not by itself establish target-component attribution. Distinguishing driver-induced failures from target-component-originated crashes is difficult because a raw report records where the failure becomes observable, but does not explicitly identify which side violated the required execution contract.

Efficiency. LLM-assisted fuzzing repeatedly mutates related inputs, so many crashing inputs may exercise the same underlying failure pattern. Different generated drivers may also reach that failure pattern through distinct API combinations or call paths. These executions can produce reports that differ in addresses, stack depth, or intermediate frames despite sharing one root cause (Jiang et al. 2021; Joshy and Le 2022; Dang et al. 2012). Treating every report as an independent case leads to repeated inspection and redundant LLM submissions, making crash adjudication increasingly expensive as the number of generated drivers and crashing inputs grows.

Crash localization. Existing prompt-based analysis commonly reasons over raw crash reports without explicitly localizing the failure across the generated driver and the target component. Because a driver-constructed invalid state may become observable only after entering component code, the visible crash frame can be mistaken for evidence that the open-source supply-chain component caused the failure. Localization information is therefore necessary not only to identify a suspicious statement, but also to determine where the faulty state originates and how it reaches the crash site (Shetty et al. 2022; Huang et al. 2024; Yan et al. 2024; Wu et al. 2014). However, existing localization evidence is dominated by static code context, while runtime context is not systematically incorporated into driver/component attribution. Static code context cannot expose the concrete values, pointer states, or object states involved in the failing execution, leaving the propagation of the faulty state incomplete and crash attribution uncertain.

## 4 Approach

### 4.1 CrashSage Design Overview

In this section, we present the system design of CrashSage, an evidence-guided crash-adjudication framework for LLM-assisted fuzzing. CrashSage is designed to improve post-fuzzing crash adjudication when automatically generated fuzz drivers cannot be treated as trusted harnesses. Its primary objective is to prepare structured evidence that supports attribution-oriented localization, remove repeated

crash instances, and retain auditable inputs before final LLM reasoning. Through this pipeline, CrashSage supports false-alert judgment, crash localization, and efficient analysis of repeatedly triggered crashes.

Figure 2 illustrates the workflow of CrashSage and aligns the three challenges with the corresponding processing stages. Initially, *rule-guided crash attribution* addresses false-alert judgment by distinguishing noise and likely driver-induced crashes from cases that require further target-component analysis. It normalizes crash reports and applies rule-based preliminary screening over sanitizer signals and stack-frame roles, producing filtered normalized crash reports for the following stages. Next, *representative selection* addresses efficiency by avoiding repeated analysis of crashes that follow the same underlying failure pattern. It constructs exact and stack signatures from the normalized sanitizer evidence, verifies signature matches, maps repeated crashes to an existing representative, and retains unmatched crashes in the selected crash set. CrashSage then performs *crash-context reconstruction* to enrich these selected representatives with static code context and replay-consistent runtime context, helping determine where an invalid state originates and how it propagates to the visible crash site. Finally, *LLM analysis* completes the semantic diagnosis by combining each representative crash's normalized crash report, triage label, and reconstructed context to determine its type, cause, location, triggering condition, and severity.

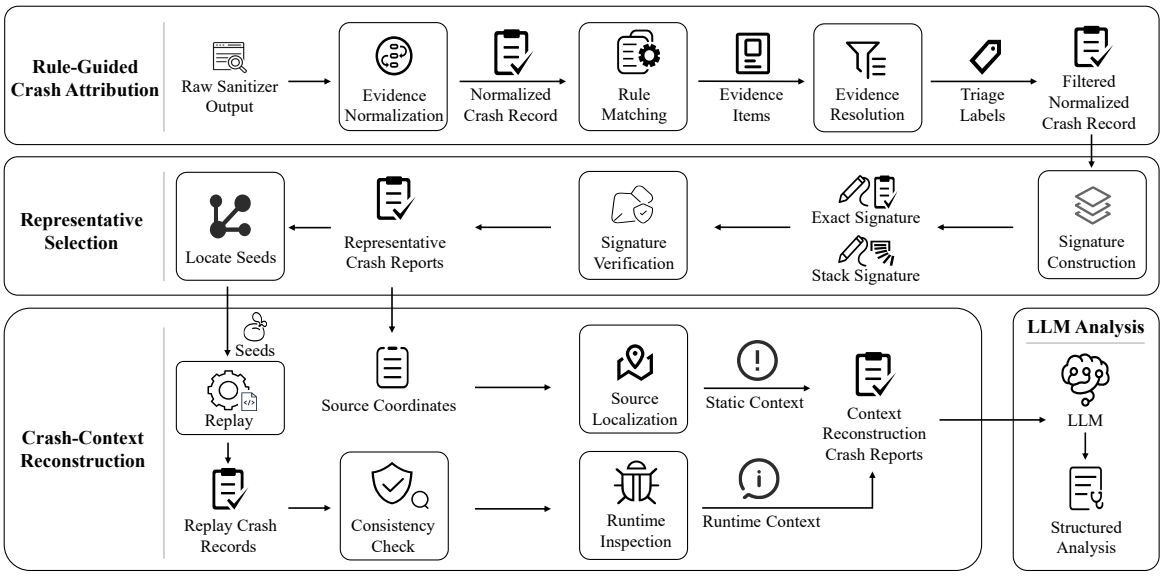



**Fig. 2** Multi-stage crash-adjudication pipeline combining rule-guided crash attribution, representative selection, crash-context reconstruction, and LLM analysis.

## 4.2 Rule-Guided Crash Attribution

Rule-guided crash attribution is the first stage of CrashSage and addresses the false-alert judgment challenge. It consists of sanitizer evidence normalization and rule-based preliminary screening. The former converts raw sanitizer output into a normalized crash report, while the latter assigns a triage label that determines whether the crash is filtered.

**Table 1** Key field groups in the normalized crash report

| Field Group | Representative Extracted Fields |
|---|---|
| Failure identity | `sanitizer_type`, `bug_type`, `summary` |
| Crash-site metadata | `crash_address`, `pc`, `access_type` |
| Severity and dedup cues | `scariness_score`, `scariness_desc`, `dedup_token` |
| Structured stack trace | ordered `frames` with function, file, line, and address |
| Project anchor | `first_in_project_frame`, `first_in_project_function` |
| Reproduction and status hints | `artifact_path_hint`, `base_unit_hash`, special-condition flags |

### 4.2.1 Sanitizer Evidence Normalization

Crash reports contain substantial redundant information that is not directly useful for subsequent crash adjudication. CrashSage normalizes each raw crash report into a normalized crash report that retains the information required by subsequent stages. Table 1 summarizes the normalized field groups.

- Failure identity describes the crash report type and its failure category.
- Crash-site metadata records the immediate low-level crash information, such as the failing address or access behavior, when it is available.
- Severity and dedup cues provide sanitizer- or fuzzer-generated hints that help prioritize and compare crash reports.
- Structured stack trace converts the raw call stack into ordered frames for later role modeling.
- Project anchor identifies the first visible connection between the crash trace and the target-component source code.
- Reproduction and status hints preserve crash-input clues and special execution states that may affect filtering or replay.

### 4.2.2 Rule-Based Preliminary Screening

Screening begins by matching the function name, file path, and position of each frame in the `structured stack trace` against predefined project, driver, and runtime patterns. Frames without sufficient matching evidence remain *unclassified*.

**Table 2** Stack-frame role classification used by CrashSage

| Role | Meaning |
|---|---|
| project | Stack frames in the target-component source code. |
| driver | Stack frames related to the fuzz driver. |
| runtime | Runtime-library frames, including libFuzzer, sanitizers, LLVM runtime, libc, etc. |
| unclassified | Frames that cannot be classified reliably but are not obvious runtime frames. |

Table 2 summarizes these roles. Frame ownership alone is not sufficient for false-alert judgment. A crash trace can involve target-component frames, generated-driver frames, and runtime frames at the same time, while the frame where the sanitizer reports the failure may not be the frame that best explains the origin of the crash. CrashSage therefore applies a set of deterministic rules over the ownership and position of stack frames to infer whether the crash is more consistent with noise, a driver-induced failure, or a target-component crash.

Before listing the rules, we define the following notations. Let $S = \langle f_1, \ldots, f_n \rangle$ denote the structured stack trace, ordered from the top crashing frame to lower caller frames. Let $F_P$, $F_D$, and $F_N$ denote the sets of project frames, driver frames, and non-runtime frames, respectively, where $F_N = F_P \cup F_D \cup F_U$ and $F_U$ is the set of unclassified frames. CrashSage computes the driver-frame ratio

$$R_D = \frac{|F_D|}{\max(|F_N|, 1)},$$

corresponding to `Driver_Frame_Ratio`. Runtime frames are excluded from this ratio because they mainly reflect sanitizer and libFuzzer control flow. Let $h_D$ denote the top-stack depth inspected for driver evidence, $\theta_D$ the driver-frame-ratio threshold, $m_P$ the maximum number of project frames treated as shallow project involvement, and $\theta_S$ the sanitizer-severity threshold.

CrashSage sets these parameters through an evidence-boundary design strategy that maps each value to an interpretable stack or sanitizer signal. The parameter $h_D$ defines the near-crash stack region used for driver-evidence inspection, $\theta_D$ defines the driver-dominance level in the attribution-relevant non-runtime stack, $m_P$ defines the amount of project-code involvement treated as shallow API-boundary execution, and $\theta_S$ defines the sanitizer-severity level used to retain project-frame SEGV/null-dereference reports.

For $h_D$, CrashSage sets $h_D = 3$ because a three-frame window corresponds to the crash frame, the direct caller, and the caller that usually reflects the immediate driver-side invocation context. This value keeps the check centered on the local failure path where argument construction, API invocation, and first observable faulty use are most directly represented. For $\theta_D$, CrashSage sets $\theta_D = 0.8$, using a four-fifths majority as the driver-dominance criterion over non-runtime frames. This value requires driver evidence to occupy a clearly dominant share of the attribution-relevant stack before assigning `likely_driver_bug`, making the label depend on stack-level concentration rather than an isolated driver frame. For $m_P$, CrashSage sets $m_P = 2$ because shallow API-boundary execution often includes the target entry function and one adjacent helper, initialization, creation, setup, or parsing frame. This value captures brief project-code contact during driver-constructed calls while distinguishing it from deeper target-component execution paths. For $\theta_S$, CrashSage sets $\theta_S = 10$ as the high-severity sanitizer threshold for SEGV/null-dereference reports. This value retains reports when the sanitizer signal indicates severe invalid memory access and the stack simultaneously provides project-frame evidence for target-component analysis.

These values are fixed before evaluating the crash reports, providing a stable and reproducible configuration for the rule-guided attribution stage. The remaining rule signals also come from the normalized crash report. Timeout, `ALARM`, out-of-memory, LSan-only, and deadly-signal flags are extracted from sanitizer or libFuzzer status lines, while `SCARINESS` comes from the sanitizer severity line. Table 3 summarizes the 13 deterministic rules, their predicates, and their preliminary output labels. These labels express the direction supported by the available evidence rather than a final vulnerability verdict.

- R1. A `deadly_signal` marker confirms abnormal termination, but the absence of non-runtime frames leaves no project or driver location for attribution. The report is therefore labeled `noise` because it provides no inspectable evidence for the subsequent analysis.
- R2. Timeout and `ALARM` markers indicate that execution exceeded its time limit, without providing sanitizer evidence for a memory-access crash. Such reports are labeled `noise` because they do not provide crash evidence for component attribution.

**Table 3** Rules used for crash attribution

| Group | Rule | Deterministic Predicate | Output Label |
|---|---|---|---|
| NF | R1 | $F_N = \emptyset \wedge$ `deadly_signal` | `noise` |
| NF | R2 | Timeout or `ALARM` marker appears | `noise` |
| NF | R3 | Out-of-memory marker appears | `noise` |
| NF | R4 | LSan-only report without crashing execution | `noise` |
| DQ | R5 | `use_of_uninitialized_value` with a driver frame in the top-$h_D$ stack frames | `likely_driver_bug` |
| DQ | R6 | $R_D \geq \theta_D$ | `likely_driver_bug` |
| DQ | R7 | Project init/option/parse function appears near the driver boundary | `likely_driver_bug` |
| DQ | R8 | `stack_buffer_overflow` with the first non-runtime frame in driver code | `likely_driver_bug` |
| DQ | R9 | $F_N = F_D \wedge F_P = \emptyset$ | `likely_driver_bug` |
| DQ | R10 | $\lvert F_P \rvert \leq m_P$ and project function matches init/create patterns | `likely_driver_bug` |
| TC | R11 | Memory-safety crash with at least one project frame | `target_crash` |
| TC | R12 | SEGV/null-dereference with `SCARINESS` $\geq \theta_S$ and project frame evidence | `target_crash` |
| LE | R13 | Assertion, abort, or `ABRT` originates in project code | `needs_review` |

*Note.* NF: noise filtering; DQ: driver-quality detection; TC: target-component attribution indication; LE: logic-error indication. $F_N$, $F_D$, and $F_P$ denote non-runtime, driver, and project frame sets, respectively.

- R3. An out-of-memory marker records resource exhaustion, which may depend on allocation demand or execution limits and does not identify a specific faulty access. The rule therefore assigns `noise` rather than attributing the condition to either the driver or the target component.
- R4. An LSan-only report identifies unreleased allocations at process exit but contains no crashing instruction, signal, or abort. Because the rule-guided stage concerns the origin of crashes, this report is labeled `noise`.
- R5. An uninitialized-value report indicates that data was consumed before receiving a valid value. When driver frames occur within the top $h_D$ frames, the first observable use is close to driver-side execution, so the available evidence supports `likely_driver_bug`.
- R6. After runtime frames are removed, $R_D \geq \theta_D$ means that driver frames account for the specified dominant share of the attribution-relevant stack. Because the observable crash path is concentrated in the generated harness, the rule assigns `likely_driver_bug`.
- R7. Initialization, option-processing, and parsing functions near the driver boundary are commonly reached while the generated driver constructs objects and prepares API arguments. When project involvement remains at this boundary, the evidence favors invalid driver-side setup over target-component-originated execution, leading to `likely_driver_bug`.
- R8. For a stack-buffer overflow, the first non-runtime frame identifies the function whose active stack object exceeds its boundary. If this frame belongs to the driver, the overflowing object is localized to driver-side execution, so the rule assigns `likely_driver_bug`.
- R9. If every non-runtime frame belongs to the driver and no project frame is present, the trace contains no observable evidence that execution reached target-component code. The crash is therefore labeled `likely_driver_bug`.
- R10. At most $m_P$ project frames limited to initialization or creation functions indicate shallow component involvement during API setup rather than an internal target execution path. This

pattern is treated as `likely_driver_bug` because the evidence primarily reflects how the generated driver configured the call.

- R11. A sanitizer-reported memory-safety crash with at least one project frame establishes that the erroneous execution reached target-component code. The rule labels it `target_crash` so that it is retained as a target-component candidate for subsequent stages, rather than making the final attribution decision in the rule-guided stage.
- R12. A severe SEGV or null dereference indicates an invalid memory access, while the presence of project frames anchors that access in target-component execution. Their combination supports the preliminary label `target_crash` and retains the crash for localization.
- R13. A project-origin assertion, abort, or `ABRT` identifies the component location that terminates execution, but the report alone cannot distinguish a driver violation of an API precondition from a violated internal invariant. The rule therefore assigns `needs_review` rather than attributing the crash to either side.

Because the rules are evaluated independently, CrashSage resolves their evidence items in the order `noise`, `likely_driver_bug`, `target_crash`, and `needs_review`. The first matched label in this order becomes the triage label; if no rule matches, the crash is assigned `needs_review` by default. This procedure removes reports without usable crash evidence and generated-driver crashes before retaining target-component candidates and ambiguous cases for further analysis.

Crashes labeled `noise` or `likely_driver_bug` are filtered, whereas those labeled `target_crash` or `needs_review` are kept as retained normalized crash reports for representative selection. For a crash $c$, let $\mathcal{N}(c)$ denote its normalized crash report and $y(c)$ denote its triage label. The output of rule-guided crash attribution is the pair $\langle \mathcal{N}(c), y(c) \rangle$, which serves as the input to the subsequent stage.

## 4.3 Representative Selection

Large-scale fuzzing often produces many crash instances that differ in inputs or generated drivers but follow the same underlying failure pattern. Representative selection reduces this repeated analysis cost by comparing exact and stack signatures and forwarding only non-duplicate representatives to the later LLM stage.

Let $\mathcal{C} = \{c_1, \ldots, c_n\}$ denote the set of crashes retained after rule-guided crash attribution. For each crash $c$, let $S_c$ denote its structured stack trace following the definition of $S$ in Section 4.2, and let $d(c)$ denote the sanitizer deduplication token. Let $b(c)$ denote the sanitizer bug type extracted from $\mathcal{N}(c)$, and let $\ell(c)$ denote the crash-site source location derived from the crash-site metadata or resolved frame location when available. Let $\perp$ denote an unavailable value. The sequence $s(c)$ is the ordered non-runtime key-frame subsequence derived from $S_c$. Runtime frames are excluded from $s(c)$ because they usually describe sanitizer, libFuzzer, or libc control flow rather than the project-driver execution path.

Exact signature. The exact signature targets crashes with the same sanitizer-provided identity or the same resolved crash site. CrashSage computes

$$\sigma_{\text{exact}}(c) = \begin{cases} H(d(c)), & d(c) \neq \perp, \\ H\big(b(c), \ell(c), \text{top}(s(c))\big), & d(c) = \perp \wedge \ell(c) \neq \perp \wedge |s(c)| > 0, \\ \perp, & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases}$$

where $H(\cdot)$ is a stable hash function and $\mathrm{top}(s(c))$ denotes the first frame in the non-runtime key-frame sequence. The exact-signature match between two crashes is defined as

$$M_{\mathrm{exact}}(c_i, c_j) = \mathbb{I}\big[\sigma_{\mathrm{exact}}(c_i) \neq \bot \wedge \sigma_{\mathrm{exact}}(c_i) = \sigma_{\mathrm{exact}}(c_j)\big].$$

Here, $M_{\mathrm{exact}}(c_i, c_j) = 1$ represents the strongest duplicate match. The condition holds either because both crashes expose the same sanitizer deduplication token $d(c)$, or because the normalized fields $b(c)$, $\ell(c)$, and $\mathrm{top}(s(c))$ agree. In the latter case, the two reports have the same sanitizer crash class, the same localized crash-site anchor such as file, line, and function, and the same first project/driver frame after runtime frames are removed.

**Algorithm 1** Representative Selection

**Require:** retained crashes $\mathcal{C} = \langle c_1, \ldots, c_n \rangle$ in discovery order
**Ensure:** selected crash set $\mathcal{R}$ and duplicate mapping $\mathcal{L}$

```
R ← ∅, L ← ∅
for c_i ∈ C do
    r* ← ⊥
    for r ∈ R do
        if M(c_i, r) = 1 then
            r* ← r
            break
        end if
    end for
    if r* ≠ ⊥ then
        L ← L ∪ {(c_i, r*)}
    else
        R ← R ∪ {c_i}
    end if
end for
return (R, L)
```

Stack signature. The stack signature targets crashes whose crash-site anchors differ but whose project-driver call paths are identical. Let $p_k(c)$ denote the ordered sequence obtained by taking the first $\min(k, |s(c)|)$ frames from $s(c)$, preserving the original stack order from the top crashing frame to lower caller frames. Here, $k$ is a fixed prefix length used consistently for all crashes. CrashSage builds a stack signature from this bounded prefix:

$$\sigma_{\mathrm{stack}}(c) = H\big(b(c), p_k(c)\big).$$

The bug type is kept in the signature to avoid treating different sanitizer crash classes that happen to pass through similar functions as duplicates. The bounded prefix of the non-runtime stack captures the driver-to-project execution path that reaches the crash. The stack-signature match is defined as

$$M_{\mathrm{stack}}(c_i, c_j) = \mathbb{I}\big[\sigma_{\mathrm{stack}}(c_i) = \sigma_{\mathrm{stack}}(c_j)\big].$$

Here, $M_{\text{stack}}(c_i, c_j) = 1$ represents a duplicate match based on the retained call path rather than on an identical crash-site anchor. The equality of $\sigma_{\text{stack}}$ requires the same $b(c)$ and the same bounded prefix $p_k(c)$, where $p_k(c)$ is built from the ordered non-runtime frames in $s(c)$. Thus, the two crashes are treated as duplicates when their normalized stack evidence shows the same sanitizer crash class and the same leading project/driver frame sequence, even if the reported line number, resolved crash location, or exact sanitizer token is unavailable or slightly different.

CrashSage evaluates the two match predicates in the order of exact and stack matching, which corresponds to the signature-verification step of the pipeline overview in Section 4.1. For a pair of crashes, stack matching is evaluated only when exact matching does not produce a match. The resulting duplicate decision is

$$M(c_i, c_j) = M_{\text{exact}}(c_i, c_j) \vee M_{\text{stack}}(c_i, c_j).$$

CrashSage processes the retained crashes in discovery order and compares each crash with the representatives selected so far. A matched crash is linked to the corresponding representative, whereas an unmatched crash becomes a new representative. Algorithm 1 summarizes this procedure.

The procedure therefore does not construct equivalence classes through a transitive closure. A crash is associated with the first matching representative, and two crashes that match the same representative are not thereby declared equivalent. Each crash is mapped to at most one representative, and the mapping is stored explicitly rather than inferred from the match relation.

The primary output of representative selection is the selected crash set $\mathcal{R}$. The accompanying mapping $\mathcal{L}$ records each duplicate–representative pair $(c_i, r)$, indicating that $c_i$ matches and reuses the analysis result of representative $r$.

## 4.4 Crash-Context Reconstruction

After representative selection, the selected crash representatives still require relevant localization evidence to refine the attribution. A component frame identifies where a failure becomes visible, but it does not establish whether the faulty state originates in the generated driver or the target component. Crash-context reconstruction addresses this gap through static code context reconstruction and runtime context reconstruction. Static code context reconstruction maps the driver-to-component call path to source code, while runtime context reconstruction recovers the execution state needed to explain how the failure propagates along that path. Together, they turn an isolated sanitizer crash label into attribution-oriented execution evidence for LLM adjudication of the selected representatives.

### 4.4.1 Static Code Context Reconstruction

Static code context reconstruction localizes selected project and driver frames in a representative crash report to source files and extracts the surrounding source-code context. CrashSage first maps each selected frame to a local file, function, and line number using the reported source coordinates. Based on these locations, it extracts bounded code windows around the crash-site frame and relevant call-chain frames, preserving the local statements before and after each key frame. These code windows provide source-level evidence for inspecting the crashing operation and tracing how the fuzz input moves from the generated driver into the target API and toward the crash site. However, static code context alone cannot determine the concrete values and object states present in the failing execution.

### 4.4.2 Runtime Context Reconstruction

Runtime context reconstruction complements static code context reconstruction by recovering execution-state evidence that static code alone cannot provide, including variable values, pointer states, and memory-related conditions at the crash point. This evidence helps determine whether an invalid state is constructed by the driver and propagated into component code or produced within the component itself. CrashSage uses `artifact_path_hint` or `base_unit_hash` in the normalized crash report to locate the triggering seed and stage an isolated copy for replay.

Replaying the seed is necessary to observe the execution state at the crash point. However, environmental differences, timing-dependent behavior, uninitialized state, or external resources may cause the same seed to produce a different crash. CrashSage therefore parses the replayed crash report into a replay-produced normalized crash record and verifies its consistency before collecting runtime context. To bind the replay result to the representative crash, CrashSage builds a replay key

$$\kappa(c) = \langle b(c), \ell(c), s(c) \rangle,$$

where $b(c)$ corresponds to the `bug_type` field of crash report $c$, $\ell(c)$ denotes the crash-site source location derived from the crash-site metadata or resolved frame location when available, and $s(c)$ denotes the ordered non-runtime key-frame sequence derived from the structured stack trace $S$. Let $c_0$ denote the original normalized crash report and $c_r$ denote the replay-produced crash record. CrashSage regards their replay keys as compatible, denoted by $\kappa(c_r) \simeq \kappa(c_0)$, when

$$b(c_r) = b(c_0) \wedge s(c_r) = s(c_0) \wedge \big(\ell(c_0) = \bot \vee \ell(c_r) = \ell(c_0)\big),$$

where $\bot$ denotes an unavailable value in the corresponding field. Only a replay satisfying this condition is treated as consistent with the representative crash and used for runtime inspection.

For a replay-consistent crash, CrashSage invokes GDB as the runtime inspection tool. The bounded GDB run records the reproduced backtrace and crash frame, together with selected registers, function arguments, and local variables from the frames nearest to the crash site. These fields can help reveal state that static code context cannot provide, such as whether a pointer is null, whether a size variable is inconsistent with a buffer, or whether an object has an invalid state before the crashing operation. Algorithm 2 summarizes this reproduction-gated runtime context reconstruction procedure. The detailed organization of the evidence produced by crash-context reconstruction is presented in Table 4.

LocateSeed, StageSeed, ReplayAndParse, and CollectDebugContext correspond to seed recovery, isolated replay preparation, replay-output parsing, and GDB-based bounded runtime-state collection, respectively. For each representative crash $c \in \mathcal{R}$, the output $C_{\text{recon}}(c)$ contains static code context, optional runtime context, and a status $\rho$ indicating the outcome of seed recovery, replay matching, and GDB collection. If runtime evidence is unavailable, $C_{\text{runtime}} = \bot$, and the static context remains available to subsequent stages.

For each representative crash $c \in \mathcal{R}$, crash-context reconstruction outputs $C_{\text{recon}}(c)$. After this stage, the evidence package consumed by the final LLM analysis is defined as

$$\mathbf{x}(c) = \langle \mathcal{N}(c),\, y(c),\, C_{\text{recon}}(c) \rangle\,.$$

This package combines the normalized crash report and triage label from rule-guided attribution with the reconstructed context produced in this stage.

**Table 4** Evidence groups produced by crash-context reconstruction

| Context Type | Evidence Group | Representative Fields | Concrete Role |
|---|---|---|---|
| Static code context | Crash-site anchor | `crash_file`, `crash_line`, `crash_function`, `crash_code_snippet` | Locates the visible crash site, not the fault origin. |
| | Call-chain source context | `call_chain_context`, `frame_type`, `code_snippet` | Preserves bounded project/driver frame context. |
| Runtime context | Seed recovery metadata | `seed_locate`, `seed_copy`, `seed_paths.seed` | Records how the artifact is recovered and staged. |
| | Replay consistency | `repro.runs`, `signature`, `same_signature`, `repro_rate` | Audits replay against the representative crash. |
| | Runtime execution state | `reproduced`, `backtrace_text`, `registers`, `crash_frame`, `call_stack` | Supplies runtime state for tracing propagation. |

**Algorithm 2** Runtime Context Reconstruction

**Require:** normalized crash report $c_0$, static context $C_{\text{static}}$, target binary $B$, artifact directory $D$
**Ensure:** reconstructed context $C_{\text{recon}}(c_0) = (C_{\text{static}}, C_{\text{runtime}}, \rho)$

$u \leftarrow \textsc{LocateSeed}(c_0.\texttt{artifact_path_hint}, c_0.\texttt{base_unit_hash}, D)$
**if** $u$ is unavailable **then**
  **return** $(C_{\text{static}}, \perp, \textsc{SeedUnavailable})$
**end if**
$u_s \leftarrow \textsc{StageSeed}(u)$
$c_r \leftarrow \textsc{ReplayAndParse}(u_s, B)$
**if** $c_r$ is unavailable **then**
  **return** $(C_{\text{static}}, \perp, \textsc{ReplayFailed})$
**end if**
**if** $\kappa(c_r) \not\approx \kappa(c_0)$ **then**
  **return** $(C_{\text{static}}, \perp, \textsc{CrashMismatch})$
**end if**
$C_{\text{runtime}} \leftarrow \textsc{CollectDebugContext}(u_s, B)$
**if** $C_{\text{runtime}}$ is unavailable **then**
  **return** $(C_{\text{static}}, \perp, \textsc{RuntimeContextUnavailable})$
**end if**
$\rho \leftarrow \textsc{RuntimeContextAvailable}$
**return** $(C_{\text{static}}, C_{\text{runtime}}, \rho)$

## 4.5 LLM Analysis

Given the evidence package $\mathbf{x}(c)$, CrashSage invokes the LLM only for representative crashes $c \in \mathcal{R}$. The LLM produces a structured diagnosis through schema-guided, evidence-guided prompting rather than direct classification over raw sanitizer text.

**Table 5** Prompt design for LLM analysis

| Prompt Part | Prompt Design |
|---|---|
| System role | Act as a crash-adjudication assistant and distinguish the visible crash site from the origin of the faulty state. |
| Attribution rule | Do not assign target-component attribution unless target-component evidence is stronger than the driver-misuse hypothesis. |
| Input evidence | Use the triage summary, matched rules, frame-role evidence, normalized sanitizer fields, static context, and runtime context. |
| Final attribution | For every representative crash, compare the target-component-defect and driver-misuse hypotheses before making the final target-component attribution. Attribute the crash to the target component only when the target-component-defect hypothesis is better supported by the supplied evidence. |
| Output schema | Return `is_api_bug`, `root_cause_type`, `root_cause_location`, `triggering_condition`, `severity`, `fix_suggestion`, and `evidence_rationale`. |
| Decoding and retry | Use `temperature=0`; parse the primary response and apply repair only when validation fails. |

Table 5 summarizes the prompt design sent to the LLM for each representative crash. For each representative, CrashSage serializes $\mathbf{x}(c)$ into this staged prompt, which we call the differential prompt. Runtime evidence is injected when replay succeeds; otherwise, the prompt records the unavailable runtime status instead of hiding the missing evidence.

Before making the final target-component attribution, the differential prompt asks the model to compare the driver-misuse hypothesis and the target-component-defect hypothesis. The driver-misuse hypothesis considers whether the generated driver caused the observed failure. It is supported when missing required initialization, an inconsistent object state, or an invalid argument combination violates a required API precondition and explains the observed failure. In this case, the visible crash location may be inside the target component. However, the faulty state originates in the generated driver.

The target-component-defect hypothesis considers whether target-component behavior caused the faulty state. It is supported when the generated driver satisfies the relevant API preconditions and the reconstructed evidence indicates that the faulty state originates in target-component behavior. In this case, the target component both contains the visible crash location and produces the faulty state. The model makes the final target-component attribution only when the target-component-defect hypothesis is better supported by the supplied evidence. This differential framing keeps driver misuse in scope and reduces the tendency to over-attribute a component-visible crash to the target component. The Clean direct prompt instead asks for the final attribution directly. CrashSage uses the differential prompt, and both styles are evaluated in Section 5.

The model output is required to follow a structured schema with the fields `is_api_bug`, `root_cause_type`, `root_cause_location`, `triggering_condition`, `severity`, `fix_suggestion`, and

`evidence_rationale`. These fields correspond to the following diagnosis tuple:

$$\mathbf{z}(c) = \langle a(c),\, \tau(c),\, \lambda(c),\, \gamma(c),\, \nu(c),\, \phi(c) \rangle\,,$$

where $a(c)$ denotes the final target-component attribution judgment, $\tau(c)$ denotes the root-cause type, $\lambda(c)$ denotes the root-cause location, $\gamma(c)$ denotes the triggering condition, $\nu(c)$ denotes the severity, and $\phi(c)$ denotes the repair suggestion. The `evidence_rationale` field records the short evidence chain supporting these schema fields and remains part of the report metadata. If validation still fails, the deterministic evidence package is preserved and the LLM diagnosis is marked incomplete. The final structured report is defined as

$$\mathbf{r}(c) = \langle \mathbf{x}(c),\, \mathbf{z}(c) \rangle\,.$$

This report preserves the deterministic evidence prepared by CrashSage together with the LLM-generated semantic diagnosis.

# 5 Evaluation

To evaluate the performance of CrashSage, we defined four research questions:

- RQ1: False-alert judgment: How effectively does rule-guided crash attribution distinguish driver-induced crashes from target crashes?
- RQ2: Efficiency: How much redundant analysis does representative selection remove, and what latency do the major pipeline operations introduce?
- RQ3: Crash localization: How does crash-context reconstruction improve crash attribution by distinguishing the visible crash location from the origin of the faulty state?
- RQ4: Final analysis sensitivity: When the evidence package and representatives are held fixed, how do the final LLM model and final prompt design affect crash attribution?

## 5.1 Experimental Setup

CrashSage is implemented in Python and uses `qwen3-coder-flash`, accessed through a cloud API, as the final LLM model. All experiments are conducted on a machine running Ubuntu 22.04 and equipped with an AMD Ryzen 5 5600G with Radeon Graphics processor. We evaluate CrashSage on 14 third-party open-source libraries relevant to connected-vehicle software functions. The selected libraries include c-ares, cJSON, dlt-daemon, expat, faad2, isotp-c, jansson, json-c, libmad, libmspack, libpcap, libsndfile, tinyxml2, and zlib, covering connected-vehicle software functions such as networking, structured-data parsing, packet capture, compression, media decoding, archive processing, in-vehicle transport, and diagnostic logging. The evaluation focuses on the third-party-library layer of connected-vehicle software rather than on a complete vehicle software stack.

Table 6 summarizes the functions, API scales, and representative deployment roles of the evaluated libraries. We collect crash reports following the fuzz-driver generation and fuzzing workflow of CKGFuzzer (Xu et al. 2025). This workflow is adopted because CKGFuzzer couples driver generation with a crash-analysis stage, so the adjudication pipeline can be extended without replacing the upstream fuzzing process; systems that target only input or driver generation do not expose a comparable crash-analysis interface. The generated drivers are compiled and executed by libFuzzer with ASan+UBSan instrumentation in Docker containers based on the OSS-Fuzz base-runner image. The testing process produces 1,217 crash reports in total, all of which are used in the main evaluation.

**Table 6** Third-party open-source libraries used in the evaluation.

| Library | Function | APIs | Crash Reports | Deployment Role |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| c-ares | Asynchronous DNS resolution | 27 | 103 | Gateway DNS |
| cJSON | JSON parsing and generation | 60 | 78 | Config/telemetry parsing |
| dlt-daemon | Diagnostic logging | 13 | 92 | In-vehicle diagnostic logging and fault-record storage |
| expat | XML parsing | 12 | 36 | Vehicle configuration and metadata parsing |
| faad2 | AAC audio decoding | 12 | 151 | In-vehicle AAC and media decoding |
| isotp-c | ISO-TP multi-frame transport | 13 | 104 | ISO-TP transport between ECUs and vehicle modules |
| jansson | JSON parsing and generation | 12 | 128 | ECU configuration and telemetry serialization |
| json-c | JSON parsing and generation | 12 | 40 | Configuration and telemetry processing in vehicle software |
| libmad | MPEG audio decoding | 12 | 112 | In-vehicle MPEG audio decoding |
| libmspack | Archive extraction | 12 | 54 | Vehicle software package and archive processing |
| libpcap | Packet capture and filtering | 30 | 115 | In-vehicle network monitoring and packet capture |
| libsndfile | Audio file processing | 12 | 76 | Audio and log-signal processing |
| tinyxml2 | XML parsing | 13 | 63 | Vehicle configuration and metadata parsing |
| zlib | Compression and decompression | 29 | 65 | OTA-update and diagnostic-log compression |
| Combined | – | 269 | 1,217 | – |

All 14 libraries are publicly available, are relevant to the connected-vehicle supply chain, build under ASan+UBSan within the CKGFuzzer workflow, and produce crashes that can be reproduced; the final set contains 14 libraries and retains all 12 libraries of the previous version. We characterize exercised API diversity by recording multi-API calls and ordered lifecycle calls involving initialization, creation, opening, allocation, receiving, use, and cleanup. The 14 projects contain 186 generated drivers, between 7 and 22 per project, and the 1,217 reports are distributed over them at 6.54 reports per driver on average. The median number of distinct target APIs per driver ranges from 2 to 8 across projects, 179 of the 186 drivers (96.24%) call at least two distinct target APIs, and 168 drivers (90.32%) include at least one initialization or cleanup call. The presence of such a call does not show that a driver covers both ends of a lifecycle, so we do not attribute a complete setup-to-release pattern to the drivers in general. The drivers recorded for dlt-daemon and isotp-c show ordered lifecycle use directly: the dlt-daemon driver calls `dlt_filter_init`, `dlt_filter_load`, `dlt_filter_add`,

`dlt_filter_find`, `dlt_filter_delete`, and `dlt_filter_free` in order, and the isotp-c driver calls `isotp_receive`, `isotp_continue_receive`, `allocate`, and `free_allocated`. Faults in these components may affect diagnostic records, ECU-to-module communication, configuration or telemetry processing, update and log handling, and in-vehicle media services.

Stateful API sequences in isotp-c and dlt-daemon extend the component-level evaluation to transport and logging lifecycles. This experiment adjudicates crashes of individual components and does not construct timing-related or concurrent resource-contention conditions, so these two crash types are not evaluated here. Vehicle-level timing failures and concurrent resource contention require separate system-level validation. CrashSage provides crash-attribution evidence for further engineering analysis; ISO 26262 compliance assessment and certification remain distinct from the component-level evaluation reported here.

**Table 7** Evaluation configurations.

| Variant | Base configuration | Rule-guided filtering | Representative selection | Reconstruction context | Final prompt |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V0 (CKGFuzzer baseline) | Yes | No | No | No | Clean direct prompt |
| V1 | Yes | Yes | No | No | Clean direct prompt |
| V2 | Yes | Yes | Yes | No | Clean direct prompt |
| V3 | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Clean direct prompt |
| V4 (CrashSage) | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Differential prompt |

Table 7 summarizes the evaluated variants. Relative to V0, V1 adds rule-guided filtering; V2 further adds representative selection; V3 further adds reconstruction context; and V4 further adopts the complete differential prompt design described in Section 4.5. Thus, V4 combines all proposed components and represents the full CrashSage configuration. Under V3, the clean direct prompt requests the final target-component attribution directly. In contrast, V4 follows the *Final attribution* design: before making the final attribution, the LLM explicitly compares the target-component-defect hypothesis with the driver-misuse hypothesis and assigns the crash to the target component only when the former is better supported by the supplied evidence. Thus, the V3–V4 comparison evaluates the effect of the complete differential prompt design, whereas V4 represents the full CrashSage variant. Per-library tables are reported for V0–V1, V2–V3, and V3–V4.

All variants share the same base configuration, which is the crash-analysis stage of CKGFuzzer: the crash report, the generated driver and the APIs it calls, the error patterns extracted from their source, and the retrieved CWE entries. V0 therefore runs the crash-analysis stage of CKGFuzzer with its original inputs unchanged and adds none of the four CrashSage stages. V1–V4 keep this configuration unchanged and add the stages listed in Table 7. The V0–V4 comparison therefore measures the incremental effect of these added stages while holding the fuzz-driver generation and fuzzing workflow of CKGFuzzer fixed and evaluating all variants on the same crash reports.

**Table 8** Ground-truth accounting for the final binary evaluation.

| Binary label | Reports |
|---|---|
| Target | 215 |
| Non-target | 1,002 |
| Total evaluated reports | 1,217 |

Each crash report receives a binary evaluation label: target or non-target. A target label means that the evidence is sufficient to determine that the crash corresponds to a vulnerability in the target library, and a non-target label means that the evidence is sufficient to determine that it does not. The evidence comes from public vulnerability material when a CVE record, an official advisory, or a public issue or patch record can be matched to the crash, and otherwise from manual verification of the crash against the target source and a local reproduction. The absence of a matching CVE is not by itself a reason for a non-target label, and a report that still lacks evidence is not assigned a label until the evidence is obtained; every report in the final evaluation therefore has a label supported by evidence. The final evaluation contains 215 target reports and 1,002 non-target reports across all 1,217 reports, as summarized in Table 8. Precision, recall, and F1 are computed over this complete report population.

The 876 reports of the original submission and the 196 reports added in this revision were labeled by matching each crash to public vulnerability material. For each report, the correspondence was established by checking the target version, the crash signature, the stack trace path, and the triggering input, and a non-target label was determined from the verification of the relevant code and of the triggering process rather than from the mere absence of a matching CVE.

For the 145 reports that lacked sufficient public vulnerability evidence, we conducted an additional manual audit. Three people with C/C++ memory-safety analysis experience took part. These 145 reports fall into 32 groups under the representative mapping produced by representative selection, and the annotation unit was the group: the two reviewers reproduced the representative crash from the triggering input, checked the crash signature and the stack trace path, and, using the API contracts and the relevant source code, judged whether the crash exposes a vulnerability in the target library, without seeing CrashSage outputs. Reviewer A labeled 31 groups and Reviewer B labeled all 32, so 31 groups carry paired labels; the reviewers agreed on 22 of them, which gives a raw agreement of 70.97% (22 of 31 groups) and a Cohen's kappa of 0.413. The unit of these two statistics is the representative group and the denominator is the 31 groups with paired labels, not the 145 reports, because a group was judged as one analysis unit. The third person re-examined the nine disagreement groups and the one unpaired group, reviewed the basis of both annotations, and performed the necessary code inspection and reproduction to determine the final label. Each group was labeled only after the reviewers checked the member reports listed for that group, and a group whose members did not share the same causal path had to be flagged and split; no group required splitting. The group label was then applied to its members, and all 26 reports that finally received a target label were additionally verified one by one against their own crash evidence, so the target labels do not rest on the grouping alone. The ground truth for this subset is therefore established at group granularity: the 119 non-target reports were not annotated individually, so a member that differs from its representative in input or object state would not be separated by this protocol. In total, 26 reports were labeled target and 119 were labeled non-target.

The 876 reports of the original submission, the 196 reports added in this revision, and the 145 audited reports therefore account for all 1,217 reports. No report is excluded from the binary metrics, and all experimental configurations use this same fixed ground truth.

## 5.2 Comparison with Raw-Only LLM Analysis

To evaluate raw-report analysis, we compare a raw-only LLM baseline with the complete CrashSage V4 on the 1,217 crash reports included in the main evaluation. The raw-only baseline passes each

original sanitizer report to `qwen3-coder-flash` at temperature 0 with a minimal attribution instruction, without filtering, representative selection, reconstructed context, or the differential prompt.

**Table 9** End-to-end comparison between raw-only LLM analysis and complete CrashSage V4.

| Method | LLM submissions | Precision | Recall | F1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Raw-only LLM | 1,217 | 0.2010 | 0.5488 | 0.2943 |
| CrashSage V4 | 96 | 0.7654 | 0.9256 | 0.8379 |

Table 9 reports the end-to-end comparison. Relative to the raw-only baseline, CrashSage V4 improves precision from 0.2010 to 0.7654, recall from 0.5488 to 0.9256, and F1 from 0.2943 to 0.8379, while reducing LLM submissions from 1,217 to 96. Raw-only analysis thus produces many false alerts and misses target-component crashes, while CrashSage reduces both types of attribution error.

## 5.3 Evaluation of Rule-Guided Crash Attribution

To evaluate rule-guided crash attribution, we compare V1 with V0 on the 1,217 crash reports included in the main evaluation. Reports labeled `target_crash` or `needs_review` are forwarded to subsequent analysis after reports labeled `noise` or `likely_driver_bug` are filtered. Precision measures the proportion of crashes with `is_api_bug=true` that are labeled true, recall measures the proportion of target crashes finally identified by the variant, and F1 reflects their balance.

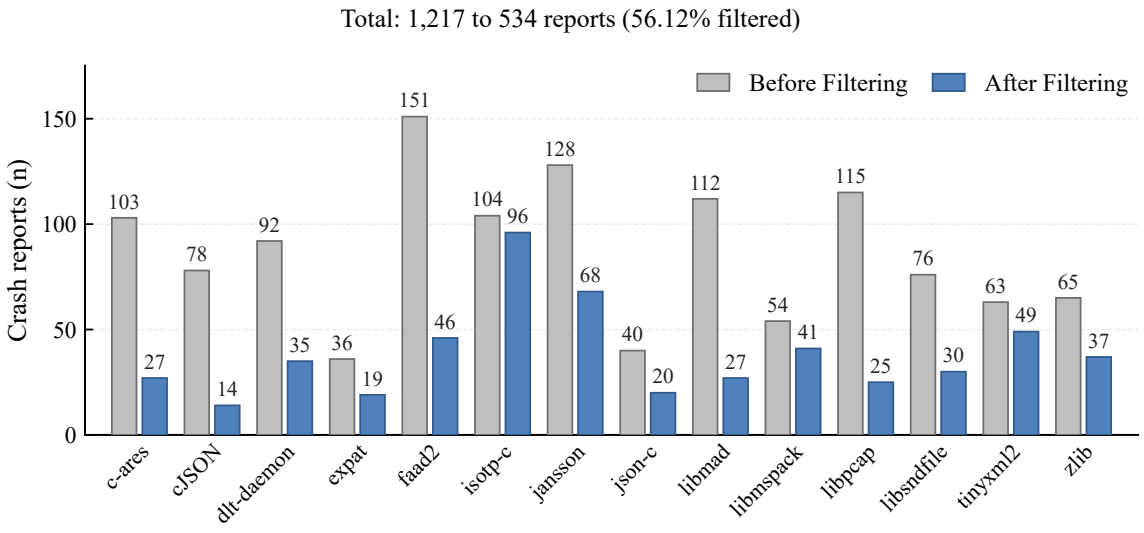



**Fig. 3** Reduction in crash reports after rule-guided crash attribution.

The filtered and retained rows together cover all 1,217 reports, of which 215 are target and 1,002 are non-target. The experimental results are shown in Figure 3 and Tables 10, 11, and 12. Rule-guided crash attribution filters 683 reports from 1,217 crash reports and retains 534 reports for subsequent

**Table 10** Ground-truth audit of rule-guided filtering.

| Triage Outcome | Ground-truth True | Ground-truth False | Total |
|---|---|---|---|
| `noise` | 0 | 103 | 103 |
| `likely_driver_bug` | 0 | 580 | 580 |
| Filtered | 0 | 683 | 683 |
| Retained | 215 | 319 | 534 |

analysis. Table 10 shows that all filtered reports are labeled false, whereas all 215 reports labeled true are retained. Thus, rule-guided filtering introduces no ground-truth false negatives at the filtering stage. V1 improves precision and F1 over V0 from 0.2817 and 0.4021 to 0.5894 and 0.6485. Its 60 false negatives are retained reports misclassified by the subsequent LLM rather than reports removed by the filtering rules.

**Table 11** Effect of rule-guided crash attribution.

| Variant | TP | FP | TN | FN | Precision | Recall | F1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V0 | 151 | 385 | 617 | 64 | 0.2817 | 0.7023 | 0.4021 |
| V0\|N | 168 | 424 | 578 | 47 | 0.2838 | 0.7814 | 0.4164 |
| V1 | 155 | 108 | 894 | 60 | 0.5894 | 0.7209 | 0.6485 |

**Table 12** Per-library effect of rule-guided crash attribution.

| Library | V0 | | | V1 | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Prec. | Recall | F1 | Prec. | Recall | F1 |
| c-ares | 0.1290 | 1.0000 | 0.2286 | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 |
| cJSON | 0.0476 | 0.3333 | 0.0833 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 |
| dlt-daemon | 0.7442 | 0.9143 | 0.8205 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| expat | 0.6250 | 0.3846 | 0.4762 | 0.6667 | 0.1538 | 0.2500 |
| faad2 | 0.2267 | 0.5667 | 0.3238 | 0.8947 | 0.5667 | 0.6939 |
| isotp-c | 0.2857 | 0.7500 | 0.4138 | 0.1951 | 1.0000 | 0.3265 |
| jansson | 0.2105 | 0.9231 | 0.3429 | 0.4000 | 0.9231 | 0.5581 |
| json-c | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 |
| libmad | 0.1757 | 1.0000 | 0.2989 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| libmspack | 0.5667 | 0.9444 | 0.7083 | 1.0000 | 0.8333 | 0.9091 |
| libpcap | 0.4000 | 0.7368 | 0.5185 | 0.8421 | 0.8421 | 0.8421 |
| libsndfile | 0.4545 | 0.3846 | 0.4167 | 0.5200 | 1.0000 | 0.6842 |
| tinyxml2 | 0.3939 | 1.0000 | 0.5652 | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 |
| zlib | 0.3889 | 0.5385 | 0.4516 | 0.2143 | 0.2308 | 0.2222 |

This result is partly attributable to the reports removed by rule-guided crash attribution. Reports with insufficient crash evidence or evidence more consistent with driver-induced failures can introduce misleading information into subsequent analysis. Filtering these reports reduces driver-side cases entering later LLM analysis while preserving target-component candidates that warrant further analysis.

The project-level results indicate that the aggregate improvement is not uniform. The affected projects form two distinct patterns: in cJSON, expat, and zlib, the evidence includes a driver-side assertion or an invalid value supplied by the driver. V0 tends to place greater emphasis on the crash site in target code. In V1, the normalized report and rule-derived evidence make the driver-side condition that determines the validity of the operation more apparent. Consequently, several reports classified as target cases in V0 are classified as driver cases in V1. This reduces target recognition and accounts for the lower F1 in these projects. cJSON decreases from 0.0833 to 0.0000, expat from 0.4762 to 0.2500, and zlib from 0.4516 to 0.2222. isotp-c exhibits the opposite pattern. The invalid bit index originates from the driver, whereas the crash occurs in a target-side bitfield operation. V1 places greater emphasis on the target code containing the failing access. This increases recall to 1.0000, but false positives increase from 15 to 33, resulting in a decrease in F1 from 0.4138 to 0.3265. These paired outcomes show that V1 does not uniformly increase target recognition. The effect of the rule-guided crash attribution depends on which side provides the more decisive evidence for the origin of the invalid state.

To isolate the contribution of crash-report normalization, we further evaluate V0|N, which retains V0's original input and adds only the normalized crash representation. V0|N increases recall from 0.7023 to 0.7814 and identifies 17 additional target reports, while precision remains essentially unchanged. In V0, crash type, access behavior, stack order, and project location are embedded in a long and redundant sanitizer report. The model must first distinguish relevant evidence from addresses and repeated runtime messages. V0|N presents these fields in a consistent structure and preserves their order. This reduces ambiguity in the execution path, allowing the model to connect the driver call to the target operation more reliably and recover target cases that V0 misses.

The comparison between V0|N and V1 can be attributed to two distinct stages. Relative to V0|N, V1 achieves higher precision and F1 but lower recall. The precision difference is primarily a filtering effect, because rule-guided crash attribution removes 683 non-target reports before the final judgment and thereby eliminates a substantial number of false-positive opportunities. The recall difference arises at the subsequent judgment stage. Since rule-guided crash attribution removes only non-target reports, the reduction in recall is associated with decisions on the retained target cases. When the driver contains an explicit assertion or provides an invalid value, V1 assigns greater weight to driver responsibility. This explains the reduced recall in cJSON, expat, and zlib. In target-side memory operations reached through invalid driver inputs, V1 assigns greater weight to the target crash site, which increases target detections but also introduces additional false positives, as observed in isotp-c. These effects jointly explain the overall trade-off. The structured report improves target coverage, filtering provides the principal gain in precision, and the rule-derived evidence changes the final assignment of responsibility between the driver and the target.

In response to RQ1, rule-guided crash attribution distinguishes driver-induced crashes from target crashes under the ground-truth labels.

## 5.4 Evaluation of Representative Selection

To evaluate the efficiency of representative selection, we compare V1 and V2. Both variants apply rule-guided crash attribution to the same crash reports. V1 submits all reports retained after rule-guided crash attribution to the LLM, whereas V2 further applies representative selection before LLM analysis. We first report the runtime of the stages relevant to this comparison and then quantify the reduction in LLM submissions introduced by representative selection.

As shown in Table 13, both stages relevant to the V1–V2 comparison are lightweight. Rule-guided crash attribution uses parsed sanitizer fields and stack-frame roles, whereas representative selection compares crash signatures without replaying the target binary. The measured cost of representative selection is 0.01 ms per retained report, so the reduction in LLM submissions does not introduce a comparable computational overhead before final analysis. Crash-context reconstruction and LLM analysis, by contrast, dominate the mean processing time per representative. Reconstruction includes crash record lookup, seed recovery and binary resolution, static context extraction, direct replay, and Docker/GDB context collection. Crash record lookup locates the archived crash record and loads its metadata, seed recovery locates the crashing input, and binary resolution identifies the corresponding executable. These five substeps take 0.32 s, 0.18 ms, 1.18 ms, 2.44 s, and 18.96 s on average, respectively, and together account for the mean context reconstruction time of 21.72 s. Docker/GDB collection is the dominant substep. Mean LLM analysis latency is 6.63 s. Context measurements were collected serially, with up to three replay/debugger attempts and a 15 s per-attempt timeout. Failed and timed-out attempts are included.

**Table 13** Mean runtime of the analysis stages.

| Stage | Mean time |
|---|---|
| Sanitizer parsing | 0.67 ms |
| Rule-guided attribution | 0.10 ms |
| Representative selection | 0.01 ms |
| Crash record lookup | 0.32 s |
| Seed recovery and binary resolution | 0.18 ms |
| Static context extraction | 1.18 ms |
| Direct replay | 2.44 s |
| Docker/GDB context collection | 18.96 s |
| Context reconstruction (subtotal of the five rows above) | 21.72 s |
| Evidence packaging and prompt construction | 0.34 s |
| LLM analysis | 6.63 s |
| End-to-end representative analysis | 28.69 s |

The mean end-to-end latency across the 96 representatives is 28.69 s, covering context reconstruction, evidence packaging and prompt construction, and LLM analysis. Context and prompt times come from the timing measurements, while LLM latency comes from the archived responses for the same representatives. Because the context measurements were collected serially, the 96 representatives require approximately 45.9 minutes of processing in total, which is the sum of the per-representative mean over the evaluated representatives. This figure is an estimate of accumulated analysis time rather than a measured wall-clock time of one end-to-end run, because the context measurements and the

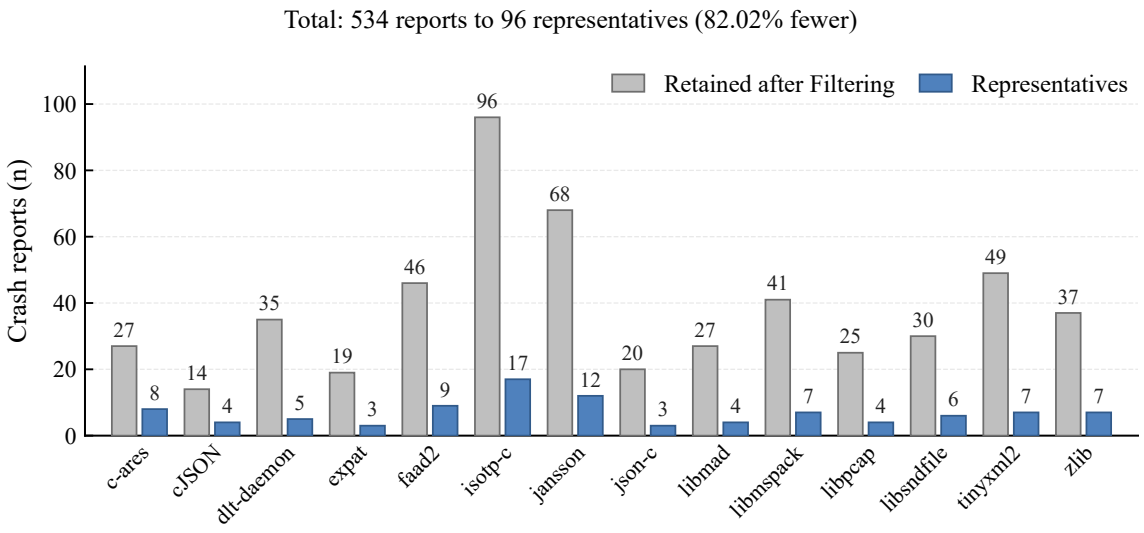



**Fig. 4** Reduction in crash reports achieved by representative selection.

archived LLM responses were collected separately and are combined through the per-representative mean.

The evaluated target API sets range from 12 to 60. cJSON (60 APIs) and libpcap (30 APIs) both reduce their respective sets of 78 and 115 reports to four LLM submissions, with mean LLM latencies of 6.17 s and 6.23 s per representative. In comparison, faad2 (12 APIs) reduces 151 reports to nine submissions, with a mean LLM latency of 7.72 s. Across all 14 libraries, project-level mean LLM latency ranges from 5.52 s to 7.72 s. These results support the potential scalability of representative-based, crash-local analysis to untested libraries with larger API sets. The analysis workload for such libraries would depend on representative count and per-representative replay/debugger cost.

Figure 4 shows that V1 submits all 534 reports retained after rule-guided crash attribution to the LLM, whereas V2 submits only 96 representatives and removes 438 repeated or redundant reports. Representative selection therefore reduces LLM submissions by 82.02% relative to V1. During inference, the prediction of each representative is propagated through the saved mapping. Ground-truth labels remain fixed, and TP, FP, TN, and FN are computed against the recorded report-level labels. In this evaluation, V1 and V2 achieve identical report-level attribution metrics, while V2 requires substantially fewer LLM submissions. Although each V2 request contains richer analysis content than an individual raw report, reducing the number of LLM submissions from 534 in V1 to 96 in V2 substantially lowers the overall LLM invocation cost as measured by the number of LLM submissions.

To evaluate group-level error propagation, we flip each of the 96 representative predictions individually and recompute the report-level metrics from the saved mapping and the archived V4 predictions. Over the 96 flips, the maximum absolute F1 change is 0.0174, and the worst case reduces F1 from 0.8379 to 0.8205. The largest group contains seven reports, so a single flip changes at most seven of the 1,217 report-level decisions.

To compare representative selection directly, we apply ReBucket to the same 534 reports retained after rule-guided crash attribution. CrashSage selects 96 representatives, whereas ReBucket selects

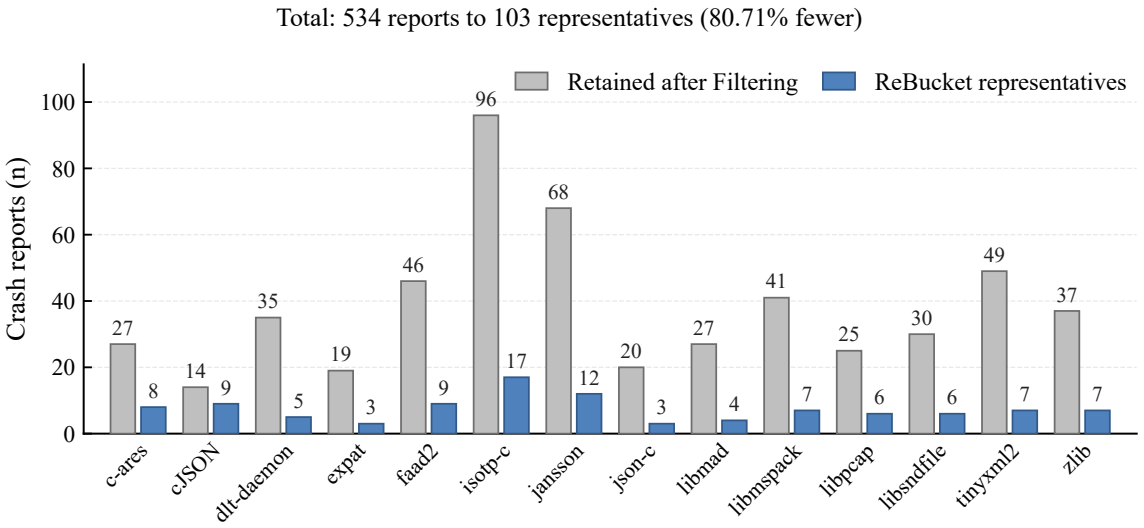



**Fig. 5** Reduction in crash reports achieved by ReBucket.

103 cluster representatives, corresponding to reductions of 82.02% and 80.71%, respectively. Thus, ReBucket requires seven additional LLM submissions relative to CrashSage on this workload. At the pairwise level, ReBucket preserves 1,450 of the 1,476 report pairs that CrashSage groups together and splits the remaining 26, whereas no pair is grouped by ReBucket alone. The pairwise Jaccard agreement is 0.9824. Igor and CrashLocator are not used as external references because both operate on crash-corpus formats and debug-information settings that differ from the ASan+UBSan reports used here; applying them would change the corpus and the attribution target. ReBucket operates on stack traces and applies to the retained reports without changing the corpus, so it serves as the reproducible external reference for the selection stage.

Figure 5 shows ReBucket's retained reports and representatives for each library in the same format as the CrashSage results. The representative counts differ for cJSON, with 4 for CrashSage and 9 for ReBucket, and libpcap, with 4 and 6, respectively. The other 12 libraries have the same representative counts under both methods. Each reduction is computed relative to that library's retained reports.

The audits use three units: representative groups, crash sites, and CVE identifiers. A report belongs to exactly one representative group, and a group belongs to one crash site. We do not assume a fixed hierarchy between crash sites and CVE identifiers, because one CVE may cover several crash sites and reports at one crash site may reference different CVE identifiers. The group and crash-site levels reduce the report count for different reasons. Reports that share a signature collapse into one group, which is the common case because different drivers often reproduce the same crash in the same way. A single crash site can spread over several groups when its reports reach the same function through different call paths, because the signature carries the call stack and a different path yields a different signature. One CVE in tinyxml2 illustrates the relation: its 13 reports occupy six groups, and all six groups reach the same crash function, so the groups differ in call path rather than in crash site. Signature matching therefore does not reproduce CVE boundaries; it reproduces crash-site boundaries at a finer scale.

We audit whether representative selection merges distinct target reports in two complementary views. The structural audit covers all 215 target reports and groups them by project, sanitizer bug type, first target-project frame, and crash function. These reports form 42 representative groups over 16 structural fingerprints, and no group mixes two fingerprints, so all 16 structural classes remain represented after selection. The CVE audit covers the 80 reports with explicit public CVE identifiers. These reports form 19 groups over 7 CVEs, which shows that one CVE corresponds to several groups; we found no group whose members reference different CVE identifiers, and all 7 CVEs remain represented after selection. Neither audit merges distinct target reports, and pairwise precision against both references is 1.0000. The structural fingerprint is an auditable crash-site proxy rather than an independent manual root-cause label, so these results show consistency with the audited classes and do not establish that two reports share an identical root cause.

The 80 CVE-linked reports are a subset of the 215 target reports; the remaining 135 reports comprise 66 author-confirmed public driver+PoC cases without a CVE identifier, 43 targets from dlt-daemon and isotp-c, and 26 targets from the completed audit.

The reduction varies across libraries because the generated crashing inputs contain different levels of repetition. In response to RQ2, representative selection reduces repeated LLM analysis over the retained reports by keeping one report for each group of crashes with matching exact or stack signatures.

## 5.5 Evaluation of Crash-Context Reconstruction

To evaluate crash-context reconstruction, we compare V2 and V3 on the same 1,217 crash reports. Both variants use rule-guided crash attribution and representative selection, while only V3 includes crash-context reconstruction. With the ground-truth labels held fixed, this comparison evaluates the effect of adding crash-context reconstruction to V2.

**Table 14** Effect of crash-context reconstruction.

| Variant | LLM Calls | TP | FP | TN | FN | Precision | Recall | F1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| V2 | 96 | 155 | 108 | 894 | 60 | 0.5894 | 0.7209 | 0.6485 |
| V3 | 96 | 186 | 75 | 927 | 29 | 0.7126 | 0.8651 | 0.7815 |

The experimental results are shown in Table 14 and Table 15. Compared with V2, V3 achieves precision 0.7126, recall 0.8651, and F1 0.7815 under the ground-truth labels. This improvement is associated with the localization evidence added by crash-context reconstruction. A crash may become visible inside a target-component API even when the faulty state originates from the generated driver. Static code context links the visible crash site to the driver-to-component call path, while runtime context records the state observed during execution. In response to RQ3, these static and runtime evidence sources reduce the 108 false positives observed in V2 to 75, remove 31 of its 60 false negatives, and help distinguish the visible crash location from the origin of the faulty state under the ground-truth labels.

At the project level, json-c increases from F1 0.0000 in V2 to 0.7879 in V3, while cJSON remains at 0.0000. This result indicates that crash-context reconstruction alone does not resolve all project-specific attribution failures. Nevertheless, the subsequent V4 results show that the final prompt design can further affect how the LLM uses the same evidence package. We examine this interaction in the next subsection.

**Table 15** Per-library effect of crash-context reconstruction.

| Library | V2 | | | V3 | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Prec. | Recall | F1 | Prec. | Recall | F1 |
| c-ares | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 |
| cJSON | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 |
| dlt-daemon | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| expat | 0.6667 | 0.1538 | 0.2500 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 |
| faad2 | 0.8947 | 0.5667 | 0.6939 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| isotp-c | 0.1951 | 1.0000 | 0.3265 | 0.5333 | 1.0000 | 0.6957 |
| jansson | 0.4000 | 0.9231 | 0.5581 | 0.3824 | 1.0000 | 0.5532 |
| json-c | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.6500 | 1.0000 | 0.7879 |
| libmad | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| libmspack | 1.0000 | 0.8333 | 0.9091 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| libpcap | 0.8421 | 0.8421 | 0.8421 | 0.6667 | 0.6316 | 0.6486 |
| libsndfile | 0.5200 | 1.0000 | 0.6842 | 0.8667 | 1.0000 | 0.9286 |
| tinyxml2 | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 | 0.3571 | 0.7692 | 0.4878 |
| zlib | 0.2143 | 0.2308 | 0.2222 | 0.6842 | 1.0000 | 0.8125 |

## 5.6 Evaluation of Final-Prompt Sensitivity and LLM

To evaluate the effect of prompt design, we compare four nested prompt variants of the differential prompt on the same representatives under the same evidence package. P0 is the Clean direct prompt used in V3. P1 adds the two-hypothesis comparison, P2 adds the precondition check and `evidence_rationale`, and P3 adds the boundary rules used in V4.

**Table 16** Nested prompt ablation on 1,217 crash reports and six-run stability of each configuration. Precision, recall, and F1 come from one run per configuration, namely the median-F1 run for P1 and P2 and the formal V3 and V4 endpoints for P0 and P3; mean F1 and standard deviation are computed over six runs for every configuration.

| Prompt | Precision | Recall | F1 | Mean F1 (6 runs) | SD | 95% run-bootstrap interval |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| P0 (V3) | 0.7126 | 0.8651 | 0.7815 | 0.7788 | 0.0051 | [0.7741, 0.7815] |
| P1 | 0.7263 | 0.9256 | 0.8139 | 0.8095 | 0.0063 | [0.8046, 0.8139] |
| P2 | 0.7453 | 0.9256 | 0.8257 | 0.8260 | 0.0100 | [0.8178, 0.8342] |
| P3 (V4) | 0.7654 | 0.9256 | 0.8379 | 0.8295 | 0.0085 | [0.8220, 0.8355] |

Table 16 shows that mean F1 over the six runs rises at every step, from 0.7788 to 0.8095, 0.8260, and 0.8295, and that the same ordering holds in the runs reported in the table. The three steps do not act on the same error type. The direct prompt yields more conservative positive decisions because it requests a final attribution without requiring the model to compare target-component-defect and driver-misuse hypotheses. In this nested ablation, the two-hypothesis comparison accounts for the main recall gain, and recall stops rising after it. The two later components remove false positives only, so precision keeps rising while recall stays fixed, which places their contribution in precision rather than in recall. The decision counts of the reported run locate each step in the error space: P1 raises TP from 186 to 199 and reduces FN from 29 to 16 while FP stays at 75, so recall rises from 0.8651 to 0.9256 without adding a false positive, and P2 and P3 then reduce FP to 68 and 61 with

TP unchanged at 199. These counts describe one run per configuration and serve as a case analysis of where each component acts, not as evidence that the same counts recur in every run.

The six-run means are the primary basis for comparing the four configurations. The gap between P0 and P1 (0.0307) is larger than the six-run standard deviation of either configuration, whereas the gap between P2 and P3 (0.0035) is smaller than that spread. The intervals in Table 16 describe run-to-run variation within a configuration and are not a test between configurations. We performed no paired test between adjacent configurations, so we report the ordering of the means and do not claim that every individual step is statistically significant.

The project-level results in Table 17 provide a concrete example of this prompt sensitivity. Only cJSON, expat, and jansson change between V3 and V4; the other eleven projects are unchanged. cJSON and expat gain target attributions, while jansson improves precision with recall already at 1.0000.

**Table 17** Per-library effect of final prompt design under Qwen3-Coder-Flash.

| Library | V3 | | | V4 | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Prec. | Recall | F1 | Prec. | Recall | F1 |
| c-ares | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 | 0.5000 | 1.0000 | 0.6667 |
| cJSON | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| dlt-daemon | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| expat | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 1.0000 | 0.5385 | 0.7000 |
| faad2 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| isotp-c | 0.5333 | 1.0000 | 0.6957 | 0.5333 | 1.0000 | 0.6957 |
| jansson | 0.3824 | 1.0000 | 0.5532 | 0.6500 | 1.0000 | 0.7879 |
| json-c | 0.6500 | 1.0000 | 0.7879 | 0.6500 | 1.0000 | 0.7879 |
| libmad | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| libmspack | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 | 1.0000 |
| libpcap | 0.6667 | 0.6316 | 0.6486 | 0.6667 | 0.6316 | 0.6486 |
| libsndfile | 0.8667 | 1.0000 | 0.9286 | 0.8667 | 1.0000 | 0.9286 |
| tinyxml2 | 0.3571 | 0.7692 | 0.4878 | 0.3571 | 0.7692 | 0.4878 |
| zlib | 0.6842 | 1.0000 | 0.8125 | 0.6842 | 1.0000 | 0.8125 |

The cJSON result illustrates how representative-level decisions translate into report-level metrics. Its 78 reports contain six target and 72 non-target reports. Filtering retains 14 reports, which map to four representatives; all six target reports share one representative. With the evidence package and mapping fixed, this representative changes from non-target under V3 to target under V4, and its prediction is propagated to the six group members. The remaining 72 reports keep their non-target decisions. Consequently, TP changes from 0 to 6 and FN from 6 to 0, while FP remains 0 and TN remains 72, yielding the F1 change from 0.0000 to 1.0000. In the P1 configuration reported in Table 16, the same representative already changes to target after the two-hypothesis comparison is added. Thus, the large project-level change reflects a prompt-sensitive representative decision shared by all six positives, rather than six independent model decisions.

The other two changed projects start from different group distributions. In expat, one changed representative recovers seven of the 13 target reports, and the remaining six keep their V3 predictions, so precision is 1.0000, recall 0.5385, and F1 0.7000. In jansson, recall is already 1.0000 under V3, and V4 corrects 14 false positives covered by two representatives, which reduces FP from 21 to 7 and raises precision from 0.3824 to 0.6500. For the unchanged projects, dlt-daemon and faad2 already

reach F1 1.0000, while tinyxml2 and json-c keep the same representative predictions and the same F1 of 0.4878 and 0.7879. Because V4 changes the reasoning over unchanged evidence rather than the evidence itself, a project gains only when a representative decision changes, and only in proportion to the number of reports that representative covers.

Run-to-run stability. The four prompt configurations defined in the nested prompt ablation were frozen before evaluation and shared across projects. No project names, expected CVE identifiers, or ground-truth labels were inserted into the templates. Project evidence reaches the model through the evidence package rather than through the template, so no template carries a library-specific instruction. We repeated each configuration six times at temperature 0 and report decision variability at both the run and report levels in Table 16. The Precision, Recall, and F1 columns of that table report one run per configuration: the run with the median F1 of the six repetitions for P1 and P2, and the formal V3 and V4 endpoints for P0 and P3. The six-run mean and standard deviation are computed over the same six repetitions for all four configurations, and these means are the values we compare across configurations. The intervals describe run-to-run variation within a configuration; they are not a test between configurations, so we do not use their overlap to judge significance.

The repeated results therefore show limited report-level variation even at temperature 0: at most 23 of the 1,217 decisions change across the six runs of any configuration.

CrashSage-V4 outperforms V3 on the same 1,217 crash reports; the quantitative comparison is reported in Table 16.

Furthermore, to evaluate whether the effectiveness of CrashSage-V4 depends on the final LLM backend, we repeat the V4 experiment with five additional LLMs. All models analyze the same dataset with the same V4 evidence package and differential prompt: the representative crashes, reconstructed contexts, prompt configuration, representative mapping, and ground-truth labels are held fixed, and only the final LLM is replaced. Each model is evaluated at temperature 0 on the same 96 representatives, and the decisions are expanded to the same 1,217 crash reports.

The primary CrashSage-V4 model is `qwen3-coder-flash`, accessed on 1 November 2026 through the OpenAI-compatible endpoint https://[workspace-id].cn-beijing.maas.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1; the workspace identifier in this URL is redacted for anonymous review and is recorded in full in the experiment archive. This model was selected on four engineering metrics: general and code-analysis capability, long-context capacity, service stability and response latency, and API cost.

The alternative backends are `qwen-flash`, `qwen3.8-flash`, `deepseek-flash`, `gpt-5.6-sol`, and `glm-5.3-flash`, accessed between 30 October and 1 November 2026. Each backend was accessed through the API provider under its exact model identifier. Model identifiers and access dates are reported so that each evaluated configuration can be identified. All configurations use `temperature=0`.

**Table 18** Validation results of different LLM backends under the same V4 configuration.

| LLM Backend | Precision | Recall | F1 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Qwen3-Coder-Flash (default V4) | 0.7654 | 0.9256 | 0.8379 |
| Qwen-Flash | 0.7597 | 0.9116 | 0.8288 |
| Qwen3.8-Flash | 0.7636 | 0.9163 | 0.8330 |
| DeepSeek-Flash | 0.7645 | 0.9209 | 0.8354 |
| GPT-5.6-Sol | 0.7645 | 0.9209 | 0.8354 |
| GLM-5.3-Flash | 0.7606 | 0.9163 | 0.8312 |

Table 18 shows that, with the V4 evidence package and differential prompt held constant, the evaluated backends achieve closely matched overall performance, with F1 ranging from 0.8288 to 0.8379 and recall from 0.9116 to 0.9256. The three backends from the DeepSeek, GPT, and GLM families reach 0.8354, 0.8354, and 0.8312, which places them inside this range, so the observed V4 behavior is not specific to the Qwen series. Because this experiment runs the complete V4 configuration only, it shows that V4 performance is close across backends; it does not separately verify the V3-to-V4 prompt gain on each backend. Backend selection can therefore follow deployment requirements while preserving the overall method behavior.

## 5.7 Case Studies

To complement the quantitative results above, we present three case studies that illustrate how CrashSage prepares structured crash evidence before final LLM analysis. They are selected to match the three evaluation concerns studied above: false-alert judgment, efficiency, and crash localization.

Table 19 summarizes three case studies corresponding to the three evaluation concerns. In Case 1, the sanitizer reports a `heap-buffer-overflow`, but the top crashing frame and heap-boundary evidence are both confined to the generated driver. The driver allocates a 20-byte `second_str` buffer and then writes the terminator after copying fuzz input into that buffer, so the faulty state is created before any target-component behavior needs to be considered. CrashSage therefore treats this report as `likely_driver_bug` and filters it before LLM analysis, illustrating how rule-guided attribution prevents a driver memory error from being counted as a target-component crash candidate.

In Case 2, the libpcap reports form a repeated SEGV group rather than independent failures. The raw reports share similar crash-site evidence and stack signatures, and CrashSage records repeated reports in the `driver_30` group as duplicates of selected representative reports. Representative selection therefore skips duplicate LLM submissions and reuses the representative mapping, providing a concrete instance of the RQ2 result: redundant SEGV reports are collapsed by signature evidence before final analysis.

**Table 19** Case studies for CrashSage evaluation

| Evidence | Case 1: False-alert judgment | Case 2: Efficiency | Case 3: Crash localization |
|---|---|---|---|
| Crash report | cJSON `driver_4_crash_1` | libpcap `driver_30` group | json-c `driver_13_crash_1` |
| Failure identity | `heap-buffer-overflow` | repeated `SEGV` | `SEGV` wild write |
| Attribution evidence | top crashing frame: driver | shared crash-site / stack signature | project frame in `printbuf_memappend` |
| Context or mapping | 20-byte driver heap region | duplicate–representative pair; 10+ reports | state-sensitive `printbuf` context; replay confirmed |
| Pipeline output | `likely_driver_bug`; filtered | duplicate skipped; representative reused | context-supported `is_api_bug=true` result |

In Case 3, the raw prompt-based analysis does not return `is_api_bug=true` for the json-c crash, although the crash is labeled true under the ground-truth labels. CrashSage changes this decision after reconstructing the state-sensitive context around `printbuf_memappend`. The context records that the driver-created `printbuf` reaches the library with boundary-sensitive position and size fields. Replay confirms that this state consistently reaches the same failing library path. The reconstructed data flow

shows that the generated driver directly sets `pb->bpos` near `INT_MAX` while keeping `pb->size` small before invoking `printbuf_memappend`. The additional static and runtime context changes the raw-report-level negative result into an `is_api_bug=true` result consistent with the target ground-truth label.

# 6 Limitations

The evaluation covers third-party-library components of connected-vehicle software. Full vehicle stacks, ECU integration, and on-vehicle deployment are not exercised, so the results describe component-level crash adjudication rather than vehicle-level behavior. The method uses sanitizer evidence, stack-frame roles, representative matching, and reconstructed execution context; these designs address driver/component attribution and do not depend on a vehicle-specific protocol or an on-vehicle execution environment.

All experiments use hosted LLM backends. A fixed local deployment would give stronger control over model revisions, but the hardware and context budget of this study did not allow one, so reproducibility relies on the reported model identifiers, access dates, and archived raw responses.

The current implementation follows one LLM-assisted fuzz-driver generation workflow with ASan+UBSan instrumentation. This keeps the comparison controlled, but other driver generators, prompt strategies, or sanitizer configurations may change the proportion of driver-induced crashes, duplicate reports, and target-component candidates.

Rule-guided crash attribution relies on deterministic rules over sanitizer signals and stack-frame roles, so its coverage is bounded by the sanitizer information and stack structure available in each report. Crash-context reconstruction depends on replaying the crashing input in a stable execution environment; when replay fails or the signature does not match, CrashSage falls back to the normalized report and static context, which may reduce localization confidence.

# 7 Conclusion

CrashSage introduces an evidence-guided crash-adjudication pipeline for LLM-assisted fuzzing workloads. By applying rule-guided crash attribution, representative selection, and crash-context reconstruction before final LLM analysis, it replaces direct reasoning over raw crash reports with analysis over filtered, representative, and reconstructed crash evidence. In particular, representative selection reduces repeated crash instances before LLM analysis, and crash-context reconstruction combines static code context with replay-consistent runtime context for the selected representatives to distinguish the visible crash site from the origin and propagation of the faulty state. Evaluation on 1,217 crash reports collected from 14 third-party open-source libraries, with all 1,217 reports used in the main evaluation, shows that CrashSage achieves 76.54% precision, 92.56% recall, and an 83.79% F1 score under ground-truth labels. The full pipeline also reduces end-to-end LLM submissions from 1,217 to 96 (92.11%). Rule-guided crash attribution and representative selection each require less than 10 ms per report, whereas crash-context reconstruction requires approximately 21.72 s and final LLM analysis uses 96 API calls. These results demonstrate that CrashSage improves attribution quality while substantially reducing redundant LLM submissions. Future work will extend evaluation to additional driver-generation workflows and sanitizer configurations.

**Acknowledgements.** Not applicable.

**Authors' contributions.** Gaoqing Guan contributed to conceptualization, methodology, implementation, evaluation, and writing of the original draft. Ying Zhang, Letian Sha, and Huiran Yang contributed to experimental design, validation, result analysis and interpretation, and manuscript review and editing. All authors read and approved the final manuscript.

**Funding.** Not applicable.

**Availability of data and materials.** The data supporting the findings of this study are available from the corresponding author upon reasonable request.

## Declarations

**Competing interests.** The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

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